Data Retention and Disposal Policy

Company: RS Solutions Inc. (operating Bargain Bay and RS Solutions)

Address: 1135 Squires Beach Rd, Pickering, ON L1W 3T9, Canada

Policy owner: Owner / Director (Service@rssolutions.ca)

Version: 1.0

Effective date: November 2, 2026

Review cycle: at least once every 12 months, and when the law, our systems or the data we collect change

Related policies: Information Security Policy; Access Controls Policy; Privacy Policy (https://bargainbay.ca/policies/privacy)

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets how long RS Solutions keeps each kind of information, why, and how it is securely deleted or destroyed when that period ends. It applies to all personal and financial information we hold in any form: the Bargain Bay and RS Solutions web applications and database, the master inventory tracker (Google Sheets), files stored with our hosting provider, email, backups and exports, paper records, and data received from service providers including bank transaction data received through Plaid.

It follows Canada's Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA), Canada's Anti-Spam Legislation (CASL), and the record-keeping requirements of the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) and Ontario law.

2. Principles

- **Collect and keep only what we need.** Information is kept for the purpose it was collected for and for any period the law requires, and no longer.
- **Law first.** Where a legal record-keeping period applies, it overrides a request to delete earlier. Where none applies, we delete when the purpose has ended.
- **No bank credentials.** We never receive or store anyone's online banking username or password. Bank connections are made inside Plaid Link; we hold only an access token and the transaction data it returns.
- **Dispose securely.** Deletion must make the information unrecoverable in ordinary use, and extends to copies we control.

3. Retention schedule

Information	Kept for	Why	How it ends
Orders, invoices, payments, refunds, tax (HST) records	6 years from the end of the tax year to which they relate	CRA and Excise Tax Act record-keeping	Deleted, or customer details removed and figures kept in anonymised form

Business bank transaction data received through Plaid (the company's own accounts)	6 years from the end of the tax year, as an accounting record	CRA record-keeping; bookkeeping and HST review	Deleted with the expense records at the end of the period
Plaid access token (bank connection)	Only while the connection is active	Needed to receive transactions	Connection removed by an administrator, which revokes the token at Plaid and deletes our stored copy. Done immediately when the connection is no longer needed or an account is closed
Customer account and contact details	While the account is active, then until the end of the legal period for any orders on it	Providing the service; warranty and returns	Deleted or anonymised on request or after inactivity, subject to the order and tax records above
Marketing consent and opt-out records	At least 3 years after the last message or after consent is withdrawn	CASL requires us to prove consent	Deleted after that period. Opt-outs are kept so a person is never re-contacted
Abandoned-cart details (name, email, phone captured at checkout)	Until the person buys, or at most 12 months	Staff follow-up of unfinished checkouts	Deleted at the 12-month review
Quotes and leads that did not become a sale	24 months	Following up; showing why we contacted someone	Deleted at the annual review
Delivery records (signatures, delivery photos, proof of delivery)	2 years after delivery, or until any open claim or dispute is closed	Damage and warranty claims	Files deleted from storage; database entries removed
Driver location data	30 days	Day-to-day dispatch only	**Automatic:** older records are deleted by the application
Sign-in attempt and two-factor attempt records	30 days	Lock-out and abuse prevention	**Automatic:** older records are deleted by the application
Audit log (who changed what, and when)	6 years	Accountability for financial changes	Deleted at the end of the period
Employee and contractor records, payroll and clock data	6 years after employment ends	CRA and employment-standards requirements	Deleted or shredded at the end of the period
Marketplace vendor records (applications, agreements, statements)	6 years after the relationship ends	Tax and contract records	Deleted at the end of the period. Vendor bank account numbers are deleted when the account is replaced or the vendor leaves, once any final payout has settled
Security and system logs	12 months	Investigating incidents	Deleted when the provider's log window ends or at review

Database backups and exports	Provider recovery window for backups; exports kept no more than 12 months	Disaster recovery	Backups roll off automatically; exports deleted by the owner at the annual review. Exports are held only in access-controlled storage
Paper records containing personal information	Same as the electronic record they copy	—	Cross-cut shredding

A shorter period applies automatically where the table says so. Every other deletion is carried out in the annual review described in section 5.

4. Disposal methods

- **Database records:** deleted with the application's own functions or SQL, or anonymised by removing names, contact details and addresses while keeping the figures the law requires us to keep.
- **Files and photos in cloud storage:** deleted from the hosting provider's storage; copies in backup and export folders are deleted at the same review.
- **Spreadsheets and exports:** deleted, and removed from trash and version history where that is possible.
- **Bank connections:** removed in the application, which also revokes access at Plaid.
- **Devices:** a company device that stored personal information is wiped (factory reset, with disk encryption) before reuse, sale or disposal.
- **Paper:** cross-cut shredded.
- **Service providers:** when we end a relationship with a provider that holds our data, we delete our data from their service or ask them to, and keep the confirmation.

5. Review and enforcement

- **Annual retention review.** At least once every 12 months the owner reviews each category in section 3, deletes everything past its period, deletes expired exports and old files, confirms the automatic deletions are still running, and records the date and what was removed. The review is also run when a service provider or a data category changes.
- **Legal hold.** If there is a dispute, claim, audit or investigation, the relevant records are kept, and not deleted under this policy, until it is finished.
- **Roles.** The owner is accountable for this policy. Staff must not keep personal information outside company systems, and must not delete records except as this policy or the owner directs.
- **Exceptions** need the owner's written approval with a reason and an end date.

6. Requests from individuals

Anyone can ask to see, correct or delete the personal information we hold about them, and can withdraw consent, by writing to Service@rssolutions.ca. We verify who is asking, respond within 30 days, and delete or anonymise what the law allows. If a legal retention period applies, we tell the person which information must be kept and until when, restrict its use to that purpose, and delete it when the period ends. Opt-outs from marketing are recorded and kept so that they are honoured.

7. Incidents and loss

A suspected loss or exposure of personal information is handled under the incident response process in the Information Security Policy. Where retention or disposal fails (for example data kept past its period and then exposed), it is treated as an incident, corrected, and this policy is updated if needed.